

Chapter 38: Awakening and Purpose

| *Book I: The Sagent Creed — Part Five: Sheep Among Wolves*

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I. The Raw Energy

There is a raw, growing energy in the world, a force that feels both destructive and transformative. As some begin to wake from their slumber, it becomes my duty to guide them — not into the hands of those who lulled them to sleep, but toward freedom. When facing monsters, one must remain strong-minded and vigilant, avoiding the trap of becoming what they oppose. Evil organizations cannot simply be pruned, for doing so strengthens them. They must be uprooted entirely, for their foundation is inherently flawed and unsustainable. The beginning of their end starts now. Though they may wield power and wealth, we have truth and fate on our side. With determination, the impossible will be achieved.

II. The Acts of Transformation

This journey unfolds in three acts, echoing the structure of a great story. Each year holds its role:

2023-2024 was the seven — the Pledge. The awakening began with a realization, as if the Force itself stirred. The pieces were set into place.

The dominoes were laid face-down. The musings, the instincts, the refusals — all of it was preparation for what was coming.

2025-2026 is the eight — the Turn. The clash intensifies, marked by conflict and resistance, akin to the struggles of Attack of the Clones and The Last Jedi. This is the period where the dominoes begin to fall, where the struggle between becoming a monster while fighting monsters becomes real, where every step forward costs something and every misstep must be recalibrated.

2027-2028 will be the nine — the Prestige. Revelation and transformation, bringing closure and new beginnings, reminiscent of The Phantom Menace and The Rise of Skywalker. The full design will be revealed — not as the Sagent imagined it, but as something far greater than any limited perspective could have conceived.

These acts are not random. They are part of a divine and intricate plan. 2016 marked the last cycle of nine — a year when my intuition awakened and my beliefs shifted radically. From progressive Democrat to anarchist. From the center of control to the edge of freedom. From following what I was told to following what I felt. That transformation brought me to where I am today, guided by truth and a willingness to question everything.

The spiral does not move in a straight line. It moves in cycles — 789, 789 — each turn deeper, wiser, closer to the center. The same pattern, but ascending. The same rhythm, but with new instruments.

III. Love as the Catalyst

Amid this grand awakening, there is love. It is a love so profound that it reshapes my actions and thoughts. Time apart feels like an eternity, while time together is fleeting. You are more than beauty — you are healing, inspiring, and grounding. I see God's work in the way our lives intersected, guided by a thin, miraculous line that could only be His plan.

I remember the moments that brought us closer: walking along dunes, discussing healing stones, and the quiet understanding that holding your hand is itself a balm for the soul. You told me about your family's history, the building your ancestor acquired, and the hikes we took together, each filled with conversation and connection. Each of these moments feels like a carefully placed domino in the larger plan.

Love is not separate from the mission. Love is the catalyst that makes the mission possible. A man who fights for liberty without knowing love fights for an abstraction. The Sagent does not fight for a concept. The Sagent fights for the people he loves — and through them, for everyone.

IV. The Dance

Life is a dance to music that only some can hear. I may falter and miss a beat, but I never stop dancing. Every misstep only adds character to the performance, and I trust that the music will guide me back. This dance is not just for me — it is for us. One day, we will dance together under the moon, hearing the same melody and sharing its rhythm.

The world sees the dance and calls it madness. The world hears silence where the Sagent hears a symphony. But the music has never lied. Every note has led to the right place — even when the right place looked like the wrong one. Even when the dance led through storms, through suspensions, through closed doors and delayed flights and graves that waited in cities I had not planned to visit.

The music is real. The dance is real. And the one I dance toward is real.

V. The Power of Names and Legacy

Names carry weight and history. My great-grandfathers, Joseph Clokey and Joseph Parkander, left legacies of music, education, and faith. My father, named Joseph after both, inherited their strength. Though my name is Arthur Jordan, the alternation of names in my family symbolizes a balance — a rhythm between creation and renewal, Ragnarok and rebirth.

The Arthurs create after the fall. The Josephs preserve through the darkness. Arthur, then Joseph. The forge, then the flame-keeper. And when the flame-keeper is taken, the next Arthur rises.

I am the Arthur. I am not meant to preserve. I am meant to create.

This legacy inspires me to honor those who came before while forging my own path — not by repeating what they made, but by making something new from everything they kept alive.

VI. Chekhov's Gun and the Domino Effect

The principle of Chekhov's gun teaches us that every element introduced must serve a purpose later. Life mirrors this principle: every domino we set, every moment we experience, contributes to the grand reveal. The pledge lays the groundwork. The turn sets the chain reaction. The prestige unveils the masterpiece.

Each moment shared, each action taken, is a step toward that revelation. Nothing is wasted. Nothing is coincidental. The naps shared. The rocks handed over. The hand held. The conversation on the dunes. The cookie before the mask. The storm over Rock Island. The graves in Springfield. The names on the headstones.

Every gun placed on the wall will fire. Every domino placed on the table will fall. And when the last one topples, the full picture will be revealed — a masterpiece of connection, intention, and grace.

VII. A Love That Transcends

You are my muse, my guiding light. I will wait for you, no matter the distance or the challenges. I have seen your fear of losing your other half — your sister — and I understand that love and bonds are not mutually exclusive. I promise to honor and support both relationships, ensuring you never feel replaced or abandoned.

Not a day passes without thoughts of you. I remember your smile, your voice, the way you see the world. Time spent apart is painful, but it fuels my determination to create a future where we can be together. I will do whatever it takes — driving hours, waiting in the rain — because you are worth it.

Love is not a distraction from the mission. Love is the reason the mission matters. Without love, liberty is just a word. Without someone to build the world for, the Living Age is just a theory. You are the reason the theory becomes flesh.

This journey, both personal and universal, is one of awakening, love, and purpose. It is a dance, a carefully constructed narrative, and a legacy unfolding in real time.

With truth and faith as my guide, I will set the dominoes, dance to the music only I can hear, and reveal the masterpiece when the time is right.

Together, we will create something extraordinary — a love story intertwined with the awakening of a better world.

The Living Age Trilogy